

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1002

By Vital

A RESOLUTION to recognize and honor Couch's BBQ for eighty years in business.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should recognize those exemplary businesses that, through their unwavering commitment to excellence, are a credit to this State; and

WHEREAS, one such notable establishment is Couch's BBQ in Ooltewah, a family-owned restaurant that has been a staple of the southeast Tennessee region for eight decades; and

WHEREAS, located on Highway 11 between Cleveland and Chattanooga, Couch's BBQ opened its doors in March 1946 under the love and care of proprietors Will and Agnes Couch; and

WHEREAS, the tiny roadside diner soon became one of the favorite stopping places for people traveling between Cleveland and Chattanooga on what was then the main thoroughfare, prior to the construction of the interstate; and

WHEREAS, since the 1940s, Couch's BBQ has offered a unique style of shaved barbecue on a toasted bun; often paired with an ice-cold Coca-Cola, this entrée has been a customer favorite for generations; and

WHEREAS, Kenny Stiner purchased the restaurant from Will and Agnes Couch in 1979; his small staff consisted of family members, and his children often helped out with daily operations; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Stiner's children, Ken and Sarah, often helped at the restaurant, with the former being actively involved in the operation and management of Couch's BBQ for nearly twenty years; and

WHEREAS, in 2019, after forty years at the helm, Kenny Stiner retired, and his daughter, Sarah Stiner, became the owner and operator, carrying on the family legacy and stewarding the historic restaurant into the future for new generations to enjoy; and

WHEREAS, Couch's BBQ has served as a pillar of its community for eight decades, and it is our privilege to recognize this iconic establishment as one of Tennessee's most beloved culinary gems; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we recognize Sarah Stiner, members of the Couch family, and employees of Couch's BBQ, past and present, as the restaurant celebrates its eightieth year of operation, expressing our best wishes for every continued success.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.